A course by Mónica Vega

HOW TO DRAW LIGHT

This document contains tips on how to draw light. Remember that the most important thing is to observe the light sources, how they emit light and how they react on surfaces.

Correlated Color Temperature (CCT)

To start, you'll define the color to use for each correlated color temperature.

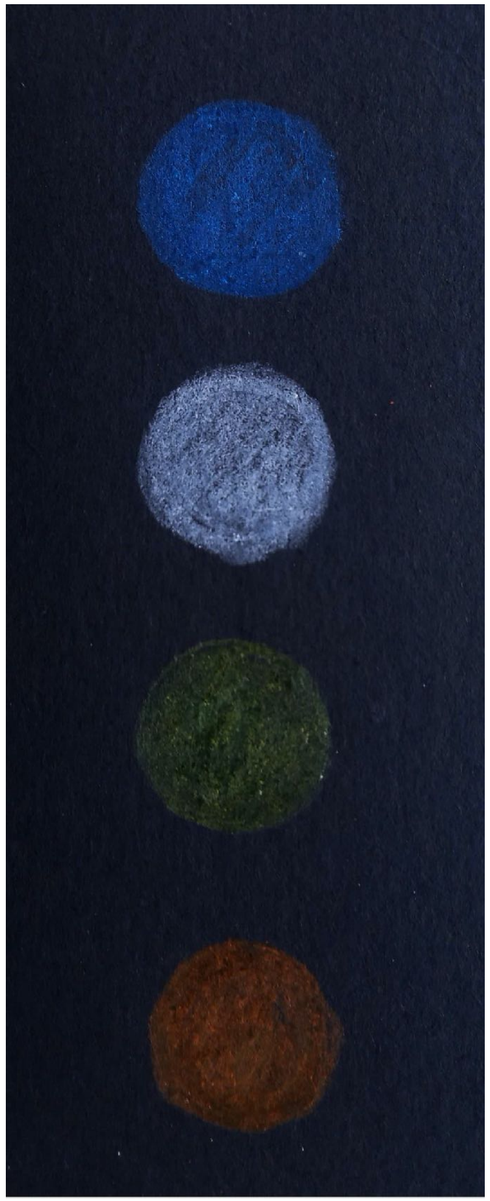
You can think of this as how cold or warm the light looks from the source you're drawing. In my case I'm depicting the light with these four colors:

Blue. Very cold light. For example, the light sources installed in a convenience store or fast-food restaurant.

White. Neutral or daylight tone. For example, the lighting traditionally used in offices.

Yellow. Warm light. For example, the light used in restaurants or places for rest and relaxation.

Amber. Warm light. This, for example, represents candlelight or firelight.



Shape of the Light Fixture

To depict an elevated light fixture, you need to pay attention to how the light fixture or lamp looks physically.

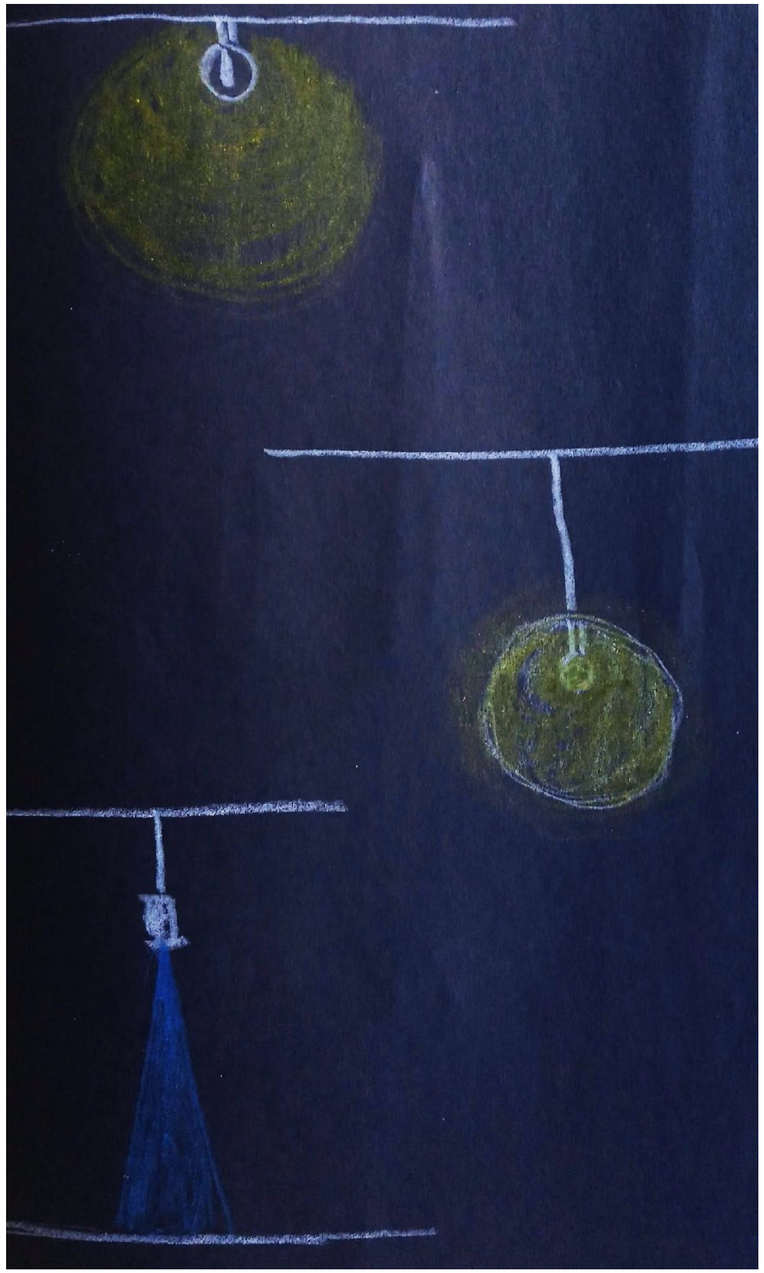
Is it attached directly to the ceiling?

Is the lamp exposed?

Does the light fixture have a diffuser? If so, how opaque is it?

How does that light fixture emit light? In all directions, or in just one direction?

Take a look and draw it.

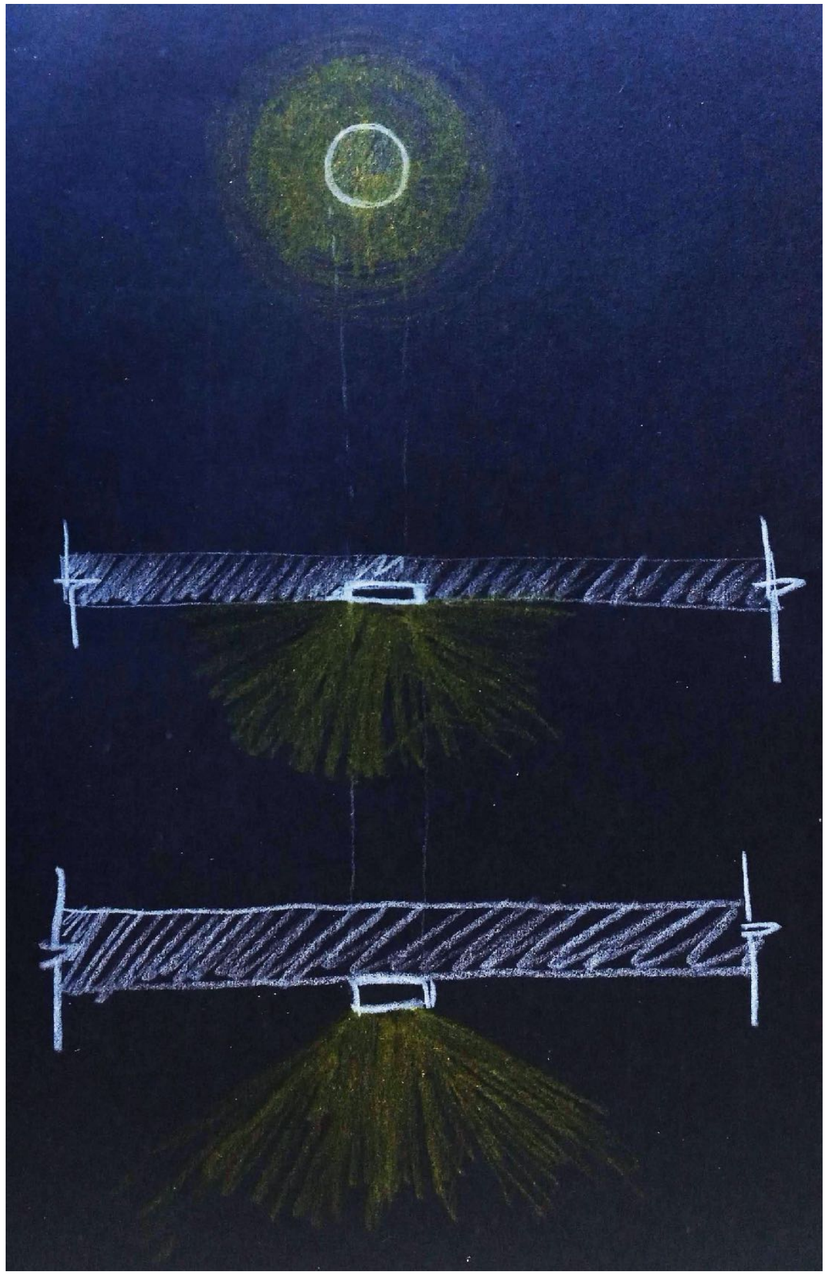


Installing the Light Fixture

In this image the upper drawing is the light fixture depicted in the scene, but it doesn’t show us how it's installed. To clarify that, you can draw in detail or a cross-section that depicts it.

In the middle drawing, we're saying that the light fixture will be embedded in the slab or ceiling, and the lower drawing shows that the light fixture is superimposed.

With these kinds of drawings you can make aesthetic decisions with your clients.



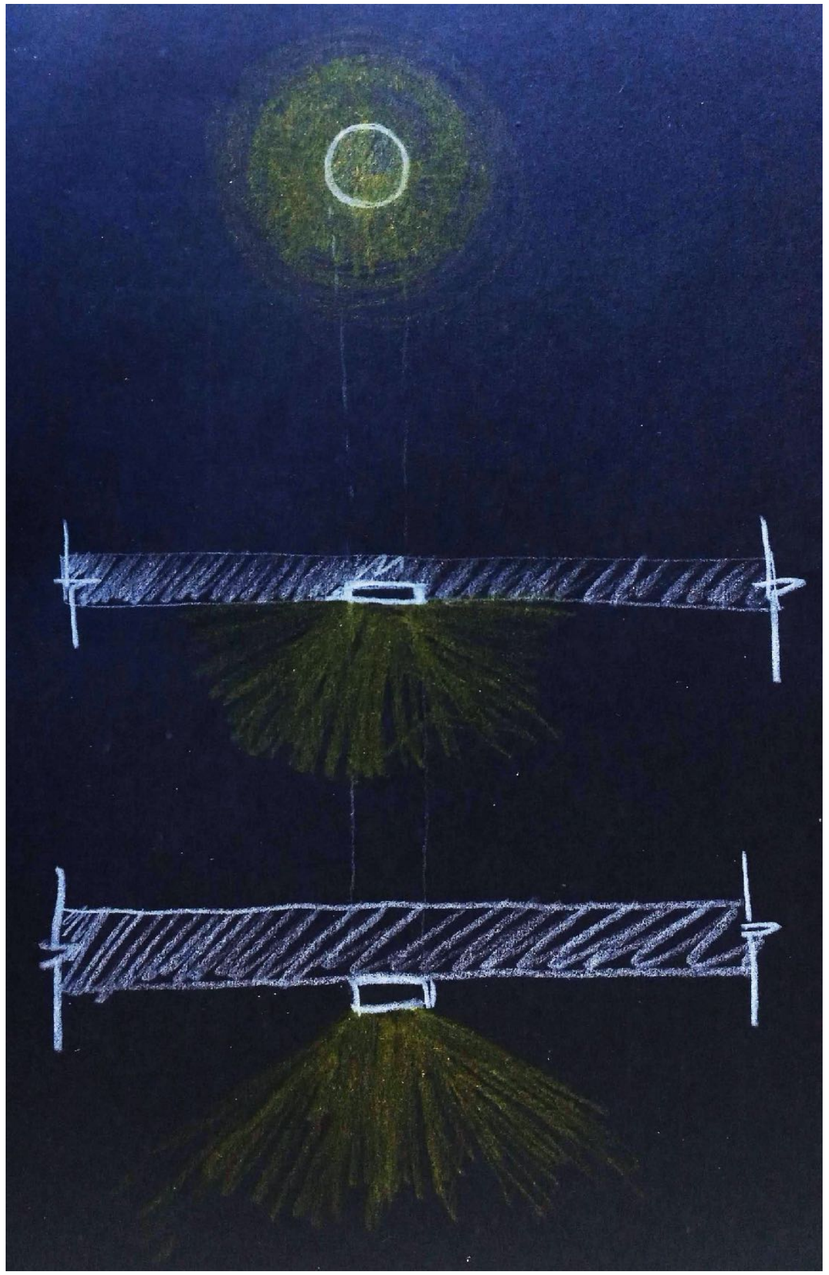
Beam of Light

It’s also important to convey what the beam of light that the light fixture emits is like.

In the upper part of the drawing you can see the light beam is depicted in the scene.

In the middle part we’ve depicted the light fixture. In this case all the light fixtures are the same, because many light fixtures have different versions that emit different light beams.

In the bottom part you can see the projected light. As you can see, the one on the far left is the most narrow, and the one on the far right covers the most area.

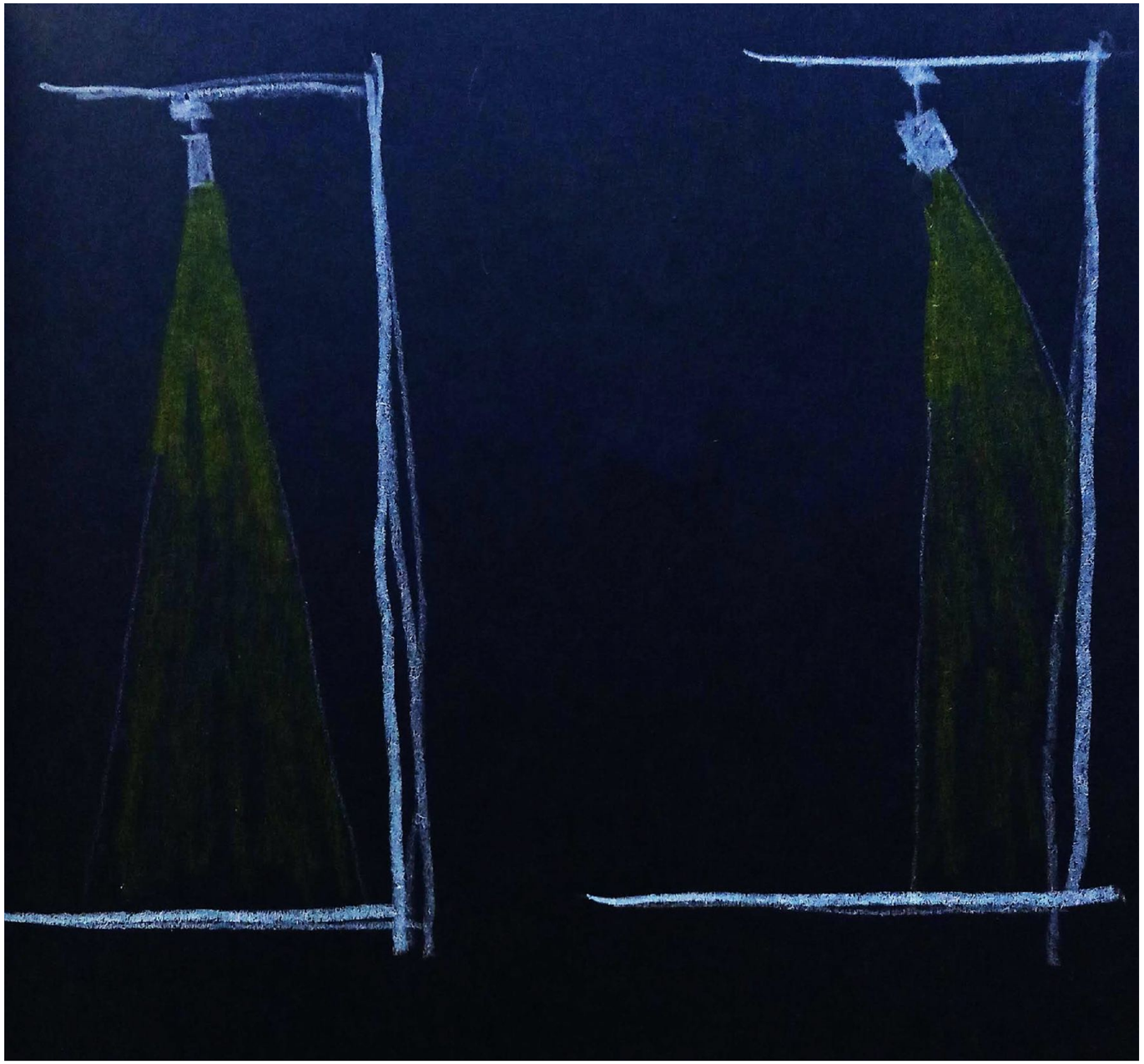


Direction

Last, you need to add the direction of the beam of light.

If the light source is directional, you need to portray in a drawing where you want the light fixture to emit light.

These drawings help the installation specialists install and direct the light fixture correctly.



Examples of Conceptual Drawings to the Finished Project

Lighting from the Register

In the upper image we explain to the client how the light will fall on the planter and on the benches.

Note the linear gradient from up above to down below. This explains that the light source is installed in the ceiling. The characteristics of the light source are:

Warm, linear light source

Architectural light fixture

Direct light

Symmetrical beam of light

The photograph down below shows the finished project.

Lighting from the Register

In a cross-section like the drawing up above you can better explain how the light fixture will be installed.

Here you can also see that the beam of light is asymmetrical. In this case, this is done by redirecting the light from the register.

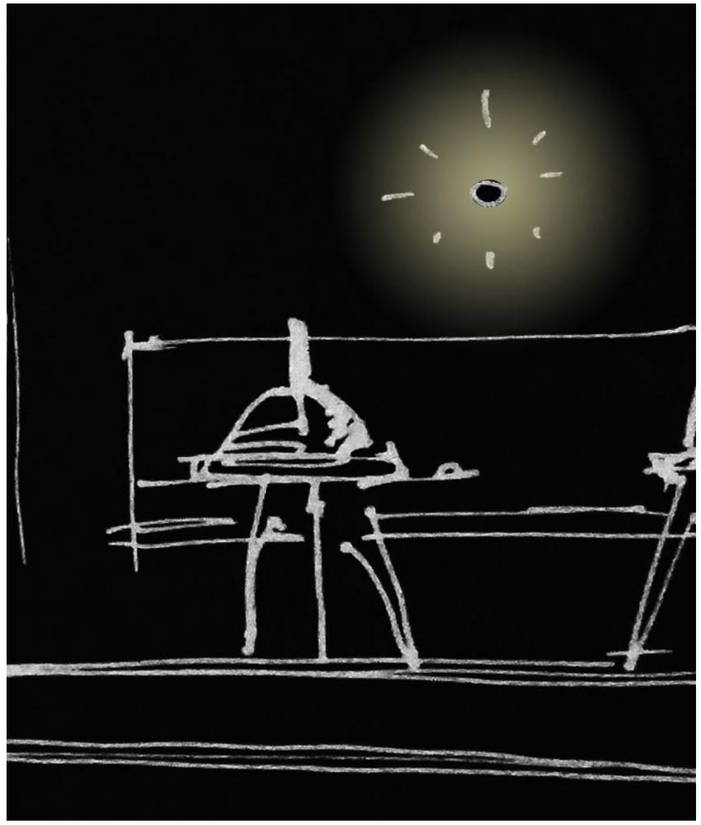
You can see how the light from the register doesn't interfere with the omnidirectional light fixture in the background.

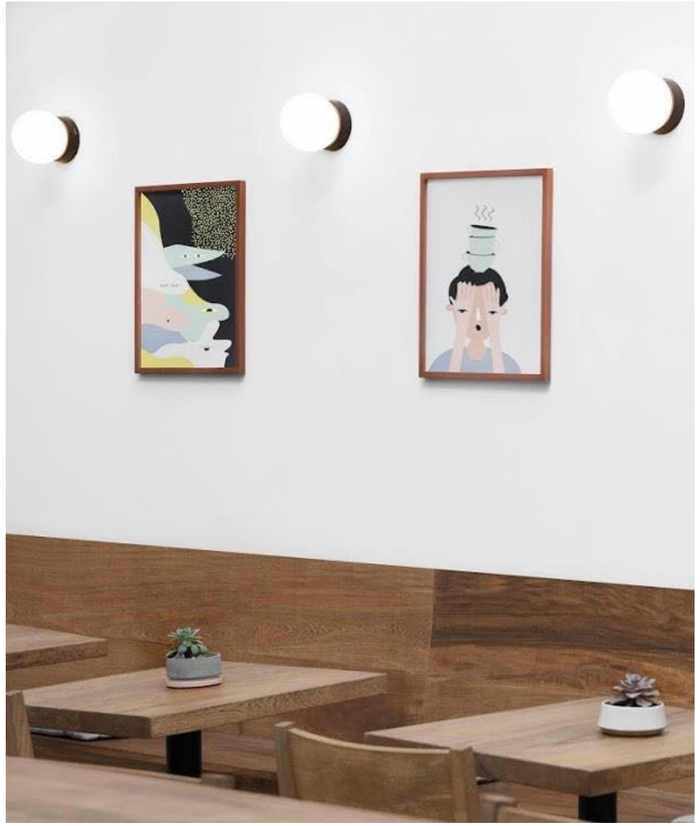
The photograph down below shows the finished project.

Decorative Light Fixture

In the drawing up above we can see the intention to install on the wall an omnidirectional decorative light fixture that emits a warm light.

The photograph to the right shows the finished project.





Detail

With this simple detail, we explain to the client how the LED strip will be installed to get the desired effect.

The features of the light source are:

Warm, linear light source

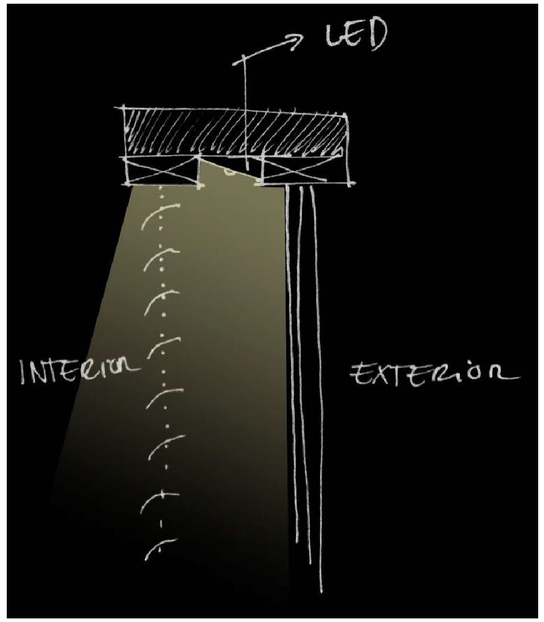
Architectural light fixture

Direct light

Symmetrical beam of light

Remember that the important thing is to make the elements of the design and the solution you're offering understood.

The photograph below shows the details of the finished project.



Lighting with Color

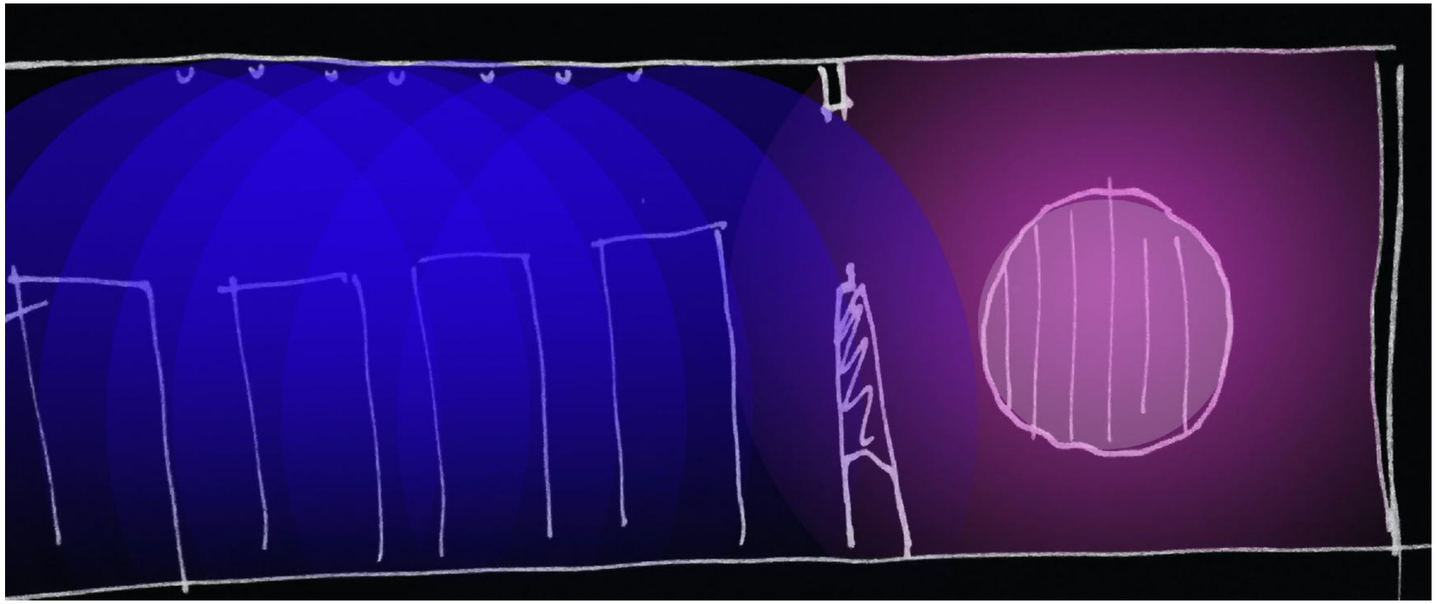
Not all light is white. Sometimes we design with color details, which we need to depict as they'll appear at the end.

In the elevation you can see the lamps that emit the blue light superimposed on the ceiling.

Meanwhile, the pink light represents a neon pink lamp embedded in a round window.

The opaque glass of the window diffuses the neon light.

The image down below shows the finished project.



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